Why we do it: the four initiatives against two objectives

Decommission R2 by October 31, 2027 and launch trading by the end of May 2027. Every initiative below is justified against those two, then against security, operations and clients. Part B is Penny's multi-firm scenarios in plain words.

The frame

Both objectives point the same way: UAM is the prerequisite for R2's exit and the vehicle for Multi-Firm; Multi-Firm is the prerequisite for trading; attestation is the control that proves the first two did their job. The only true conflict is capacity.

Initiative	R2 decommission (Oct 31, 2027)	Trading GA (end of May 2027)	Stage
Unified Access Management	Replaces the R2 request channels (myRequest, steward portal); links legacy IDs at request close	Provisions trading access at scale into packages; the vehicle Multi-Firm extends	Design complete — handover to engineering
Multi-Firm	Every SZ/R2 ID must sit behind one CX identity before shutdown	Hard gate: sub-advisors trade across firms and live on NetRep today	Discovery done — design next
Self-serve user management	IB firms self-serve user admin in R2 today; needs a CX equivalent	Deactivation from the list is the offboarding control	Scoping — P1 slice of UAM
Unified CX attestations	Lets the file-based process retire; certifies linked IDs	Trading raises the bar for certifying who can act on which accounts	Backlog — after the user list

1 · Unified Access Management — why it is necessary, and why first

What it solves in one line: today access is requested through three channels, fulfilled from a spreadsheet and free-text instructions, and never traceable afterwards.

Lens	Justification	Evidence
R2 decommission	The client request channels live in R2: myRequest (PM/IFM) and the steward portal (IB self-serve). No replacement intake means R2 cannot be switched off. UAR is that replacement, and request close-out is where legacy IDs get linked behind the CX profile — a precondition for the shutdown.	Post-launch retirement list: R2 steward portal, R2 myRequest, iMOST UAF; ~$5M/yr case; notifications also need FNUM endpoints to leave R2
Trading GA	Trading access has to be provisioned at scale into packages, and FNUM authorizes every order. A platform-wide launch through today's process is exactly how misregistration incidents happen.	3 misregistration incidents in 2026 plus a live client given an untested orders module (Nov 2025)
Security and audit	No auditable trail from request to access; the catalogue sits on a personal drive; RR codes are typed into comment boxes; IDs are emailed to clients; requests are untracked; ID Admin never sees the firm relationship.	Audit findings on access governance; the bank SSO/2FA decree; one-time credential handling exists only in the new design

Operations	One person = two or more requests across CX, SZ, R2 and NetRep; 48-hour SLA vs 2 days–2 weeks actual; wrong-firm creations with no way to move an ID; reconciliation burden on engineering.	~9,000 users; Fiera cannot request until the day before a start date; john.doe → john.doe1
Platform integrity	The feature registry and PCR are the catalogue every new module must register into — trading features, servicing uploads, estates, Infinite modules. Without it, feature onboarding stays manual and modules keep being built differently.	Feature-registration process since June 2026; the Infinite "tools" dumping ground; trade allocations built with its own permission model
Clients	Stewards juggle two processes and have no view of their own users; firms asked for one place.	Guardian, Harbourfront, Fiera and RN Croft discoveries; unified-experience and NPS objectives
Readiness	The only initiative that is design-complete and validated — it can go to engineering now.	6 flow specs; prototype checked against 20 production Okta packages; Feature Onboarding Plan written

Why first, regardless of Multi-Firm

- R2 decommission needs it even if Multi-Firm never happened.
- Trading provisioning needs the registry and packages either way.
- The incidents and the audit exposure exist today, not in 2027.
- Multi-Firm is expressed through its form, registry and user list — building Multi-Firm first means building a request form inside Multi-Firm anyway (Penny: "we would never have a form").
- It is the only initiative ready for engineering now.

> **On the 6-month / 2-PI estimate.** The answer is not to skip UAM but to split it. PI-1 delivers the Multi-Firm-enabling slice only — catalogue and PCR, request form with a firm-context parameter, lifecycle, ID Admin workspace, credentials, user list. PI-2 carries the rest (provisioning diff, monitoring extras, bilingual labels, export, external systems) in parallel with the Multi-Firm build. Ask engineering for the estimate by P-level, not for the whole. If one team must do both sequentially, May is not reachable, and the honest fallback is trading GA for single-firm users with sub-advisors staying on NetRep until Multi-Firm lands — which delays the NetRep exit but saves the launch.

2 · Multi-Firm — what it solves, how to prioritize

What it solves: Compass assumes one person belongs to one firm; 40% of firms don't. Multi-Firm makes cross-firm access legitimate, visible and revocable instead of improvised.

Justifications

- **Trading:** cannot launch for sub-advisors without it — 45 sub-advisors serving 35 firms; 741 R2 profiles carry sub-advisor RR codes.
- **Privacy exposure is live:** Secured Zone checks no firm boundary; invalid cross-firm access was found only after weeks of analysis.
- **R2 and NetRep exits** need every legacy ID linked to one identity — a Harbourfront user holds up to 28.
- **Attestations** cannot see parent users today.
- **Enterprise clients** carry the burden and are where NBIN grows through M&A: 85 parent groups, 184 child firms.

Fitting the timeline (design 2 months, handover 1 month, build one quarter)

Window	Multi-Firm	In parallel
Nov–Dec 2026	Design with Owen and JP: relationship model held in CX, firm-context step in the request form, parent package, delegate bundles; governance pack with Ed and Jonathan; identity decision (one ID or two) sized by engineering	UAM PI-1 build
Jan 2027	Handover; Firm360 Parent_Code consumed when ready, delegation table deferred	UAM PI-1 finishing
Feb–Apr 2027	Build on the UAM slice: delegation for sub-advisors first (trading-only access), parent/child provisioning second (same mechanism)	UAM PI-2
Apr–May 2027	Beta and pilot with firms that have no sub-advisory; sub-advisors migrate with trading GA	—

Deferred inside Multi-Firm: parent-aware attestation, usage reporting to Firm360, automated termination, feature inheritance, parent-of-parent. **Critical-path order:** sub-advisors (trading) before parents (strategic), even though parents are the larger population.

3 · Unified CX User Attestations — business justification

What it solves: attestation is the control that proves access is reviewed, and today it is unreliable.

- **Regulatory:** audit findings on access governance and the quarterly risk-committee lens — a control that works only on paper is a finding waiting to recur.
- **Current failure modes, from the discoveries:** files per child firm over SFTP that Harbourfront could not reach; Guardian cannot tell which report arrived; R2/SZ/NetRep attested only annually; parent users and relationships untagged; stewards reconcile against their own spreadsheets; leavers found only at the quarterly review (RN Croft); access lingering across two cycles (Fiera); stale access confirmed by the RVPs; Secured Zone granting more than R2 and NetRep for the same person. Penny's own verdict on the existing attestation feature: it failed.
- **R2 decommission:** the file-based process leans on legacy user lists; a CX-native attestation that certifies linked IDs is what lets the files retire.
- **Trading:** once people can trade from Compass, certifying who can act on which accounts becomes a first-order control, not a reporting exercise.

- **Value:** one certification per person across linked IDs, an evidence trail, relationship-level confirmation (the delegating firm confirms the agreement still stands), fewer missed deactivations, less manual report production at NBIN.

It can start on the user list without Multi-Firm; it only becomes complete with it.

4 · Self-serve user management — why it still matters

- **R2 decommission:** IB firms self-serve user administration in the R2 steward portal today. Retiring R2 without an equivalent in CX removes a capability firms already have — self-serve is an R2-exit dependency, not a nicety.
- **Everything above stands on the list:** attestation needs it, a parent steward needs it to see users across the group, and deactivation from it is the offboarding control.
- **The internal list is not client-ready:** statuses disagree between FNUM and Okta, resources are unlabelled, and the defect list dates from the 2023 launch. That fix is needed for attestation anyway.

It is already inside UAM as the P1 steward-monitoring slice, so it is a sizing question, not a new project: list plus initiate action in PI-1, everything else later.

Part B · Penny's multi-firm scenarios, in simple words

Penny walked through two kinds of "scenarios": the real-world firm situations the model has to handle, and the solution choices she left open.

> **The simple version:** three real patterns matter (parent/child, sub-advisor, referral), two are explicitly out (ghost parents, parent-of-parent), and the big open call is one ID versus two for sub-advisors.

Firm situations

#	Scenario	Real example	What Penny said
1	**Parent with child firms** (M&A rebrand, or IB + PM arms)	Harbourfront (5 children); Wellington-Altus (IB + PM)	The core case. Parent users need one ID across the children. One layer of hierarchy only.
2	**PM + IFM pair grouped by NBIN for reporting** ("ghost parent")	Many PM/IFM pairs	Not a real parent: no users, accounts or contract. Never treat it as one.
3	**Sub-advisory (delegation)**	Fiera owns the client, Guardian trades; Guardian also trades for Kensel and Dundee	Trading-only access to delegated accounts. The home firm (Guardian) administers its users; the delegating firm (Fiera) authorizes and confirms.
4	**Referral agent**	Tricert's accountant partners	A second delegation type: view-only, maybe account opening. No trading.
5	**Acquisition not yet merged**	Harbourfront bought Cumberland (itself a parent of four)	Stays separate until the firm merges operations and renegotiates contracts; then Firm360 is updated.
6	**Ownership stake without supervision** ("parent of parent")	Guardian's majority stake in Rae & Lipsky	Out of scope. Parent means direct ownership, supervision and accountability.
7	**Multi-parent (transitional)**	Harbourfront + KJH before May 2026	An edge case that resolves itself; don't design for it.

Solution choices she laid out

Choice	Options	Her lean
Sub-advisor identity	One ID with several feature profiles (~3 extra months) vs two credentials: home ID + trading-only "sub-advisory" ID	Two credentials, on time grounds — but get R&D's cost of the one-ID option first
Parent feature package	One global parent package with everything (manual) vs inherit from children vs from Firm360	Simple global package; no inheritance automation
Parent views in apps	Aggregate parent view vs toggle firm context per app vs firm labels in every module	Let Owen offer two options; Servicing already aggregates and can't change
Firm360 dependency	Wait for Firm360 vs CX keeps its own relationship model and syncs later	Don't wait — design with Owen/JP now, validate with Ray
The ~600 non-standard IDs	Build for them vs tactical offline path until multi-firm	Tactical path; multi-firm removes the problem

Transition cases she asked to be explored

A child added to or removed from a parent; the security steward of a dissolved parent being set up again; what happens to user assignments when a firm context is removed.

Appendix · Aggregation and delegation examples, as Penny described them

Aggregation (parent → child)

Scenario	Example	Problem today	What Penny concluded
Parent group built by acquisitions	Harbourfront: Harbourfront IB, KJ Harrison, Rothenberg, Wealth Council… Aaron in the back office exists in seven firms; a user there can hold up to 28 IDs (7 CX, 7 NetRep, 7 SZ)	Head office has to log into every firm; attestation sees seven Aarons, not one person	The core case. Set the person up once at the parent; one ID with RR codes from the children
One business with two arms	Wellington-Altus: an IB firm that spun off a PM firm	Same people, two registrations, two sets of logins	Parent/child, one layer; the parent inherits what both arms subscribe to
Pair grouped only for NBIN reporting	PM + IFM pairs NBIN groups for P&L	Looks like a parent in the data	Not a real parent: no users, accounts or contract. Never register anyone there
Parent that only does some operations	Guardian Capital: most business and stewards sit in the child firms; the parent steward knows little about the children's users	Each child keeps its own steward	Fine as is — anyone who manages both gets set up at the parent
Acquisition not yet merged	Harbourfront bought Cumberland (April 2026); Cumberland is itself a parent of two IBs, an IFM and a PM	Two parent groups that are legally one	Keep them separate until the firm merges operations and renegotiates contracts; then Firm360 is updated
Ownership stake without supervision	Guardian holds a majority of Rae & Lipsky (a parent of three); its COO asked NBIN for support	Looks like parent-of-parent	Out of scope. Parent means direct ownership, supervision and accountability
Feature mix after a merger	The IB arm pays for research; the acquired PM arm pays for bulk uploads; or IB on Croesus, PM on Digit	What does a parent user get?	Everything the children have; count usage and bill by metering, no licence caps in Compass
Legacy-ID edge	Industrial Alliance needs a second R2 ID to see systematic plans in another branch	Only one R2 ID can link to a CX profile	Don't solve it; it disappears when sys plans is rebuilt in CX in 2027

Delegation (firm → partner)

Scenario	Example	Problem today	What Penny concluded
Sub-advisory	The investor signs with Fiera; Fiera delegates portfolio management to Guardian; a Guardian PM trades Fiera accounts. Guardian also sub-advises Kensel and Dundee	Guardian's PM is created inside Fiera as if an employee: three extra IDs, and Fiera's steward attests people Fiera doesn't employ	Fiera authorizes; Guardian's steward administers; access is trading only
Same person, two roles	A Guardian PM with full access on Guardian accounts and trading-only on Fiera's	One ID can only carry one package	Current thinking: two credentials — a home-firm ID and one "sub-advisory" trading ID covering all delegating firms; ask R&D what one ID with two profiles would cost
Two firms sharing a sub-advisor	Firm X and Firm W each delegate accounts to Firm Y (her whiteboard)	Y's steward could grant more than X allowed	X's authorization defines the ceiling; CX must stop Y assigning beyond it
Referral agent	Tricert: accounting firms own the client relationship, Tricert runs the wealth side, the accountants need to see the accounts	They look like ordinary employees with cross-firm access	A second delegation type: view only, sometimes account opening. Suzanne and Matt have the list
Governance	Who authorizes, attests and revokes	Agreement on paper; nobody is sure who certifies what	Agreement and Ed's risk review before any release; home firm attests its people; delegating firm confirms the relationship and can revoke

The pattern she kept coming back to: aggregation is "I own it, give me the whole picture"; delegation is "I lend you a slice, and you can't take more than I lent."

Sources: Penny Lam's KT sessions (planning board, multi-firm "why", multi-firm final review, feature onboarding process), the UAM handover material, client discoveries (Harbourfront, Guardian, Fiera, RN Croft), the Sub-Advisor RVP review and the parent-firm / R2 / SZ data analyses.